



Aki Fukai

Principal Product Designer, Enterprise SaaS & Regulated Platforms

Location: Hamburg, Germany (Hybrid/Remote) | **Work Permit:** Swiss citizen, EU/EFTA | **Contract:** B2B Retainer (3–18+ months)

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Professional Summary

Principal Product Designer with 20+ years in digital product and service design, focused for the last 13 years on high-complexity B2B SaaS, regulated platforms, and AI-driven workflows. Track record of turning strict compliance mandates, multi-tenant RBAC architectures, and high-volume data into scalable, audit-proof platforms, from product discovery to production-ready design systems. *Two decades operating primarily on B2B contracts, with two client engagements that converted to permanent roles.*

Technical Skills & Core Competencies

- **Design Systems & UI Architecture:** Multi-brand and multi-tenant systems, semantic token taxonomy, component lifecycle, design system migration, zeroheight, Storybook, Design Ops
- **Interface Design & Accessibility:** High-density dashboards, multi-device systems (web, mobile, POS), accessibility (WCAG 2.1, WCAG 2.2, BITV 2.0, EN 301 549)
- **Design Engineering & AI Tooling:** Figma (variables, tokens, auto layout), Claude Code (CLI), Model Context Protocol (MCP), design-to-code pipelines, CSS variables, CSS transitions, Git workflows, VS Code
- **Methods & Strategy:** Shape Up framework, Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD), Event Storming, Service Design, Lean UX, Prototyping, Audit-to-Implementation Cycles
- **Collaboration Tools:** Notion, Miro, FigJam, Excalidraw, Jira, Asana, Linear, Slack

Professional Experience

Principal Product Designer & Design System Consultant

Independent Consultant

Freelance contract · Remote/On-site · Jul 2024 – Present

- **Stealth PropTech Startup** (Jan 2025 – Present): Created the brand identity and a zero-to-one design system that shortened initial frontend work on core modules.
- **Healthcare SaaS Platform** (Jan 2025 – Mar 2025): Led product discovery and built a validated UX roadmap to de-risk platform expansion in a regulated clinical environment.
- **Ringer** (ATOSS/HR Tech SaaS) (Jan 2025 – May 2025): Led the UX architecture, rebranding, and relaunch; moved enterprise HR workflows onto modern design token standards.
- **1komma5°** (Clean Energy) (Jul 2024 – Dec 2024): Consulted on design system optimization and shipped cross-device component libraries that sped up work across internal product squads.

Design Director

whatever.works (JobRad Venture) · HR-Tech

Freelance contract · Remote · May 2023 – Jun 2024

- Launched a market-ready MVP in 70 days using Shape Up; it reached 30+ enterprise clients in year one.
- Built multi-tenant UX compliance for 150+ international jurisdictions, with Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), Single Sign-On (SSO), and HRIS API integrations.

- Cut design-to-engineering handoff friction with tokenized component governance; the product's ease of use helped earn a "Best HR Startup 2023" award.
- Recruited and led a design team; set up async design ops; mentored staff to own feature delivery end to end.

Co-Founder & Founding Designer

Hello Meet · Privately Funded Start-Up

Co-founder · Hamburg/Remote · Jan 2018 – Mar 2024

- Led product strategy and 0-to-1 design across iOS, Android, and Web for a group scheduling app.
- Used the Jobs-to-be-Done (JTBD) framework and purpose-built mapping tools for hypothesis testing, user discovery, and conversion rate optimization.
- Built local-first C2B business model and service flows; validated purchase intent through lean experiments.
- Designed and maintained cross-platform UI and design systems across iOS, Android, and Web.

Principal Product Designer

PlasticPlan (Henkel Venture) · RegTech

Freelance contract · Remote · Feb 2022 – Jul 2022

- Designed AI-driven classification UX for automated plastic tax compliance, enabling enterprise users to cut regulatory reporting costs by up to 80%.
- Built audit-proof dashboards for high-throughput workflows across 236M+ data points, 800K+ packaging components, and 160K+ auto-classified products.
- Translated AI validation models into low-cognitive-load interfaces that improved human-in-the-loop audit accuracy and verification speed.
- Delivered a scalable, bilingual (DE/EN) component library that met EU sustainability and reporting standards.

Senior Product Designer

enfore AG · Commerce OS, Retail FinTech

Freelance-to-permanent · Hamburg (hybrid) · Jun 2018 – May 2020

- Designed POS and ERP software platform distributed by major European telecommunications partners.
- Optimized retail workflows for barcode scanning, inventory tracking, fast role switching, and multi-location database synchronization.
- Created modular KPI dashboards for real-time multi-store monitoring and end-to-end order fulfilment.
- Scaled complex multi-device UI across desktop, tablet, mobile, and custom POS hardware for non-technical SMB operators.

Founding Senior Interaction Designer

collectAI (Otto Group) · FinTech

Freelance-to-permanent · Hamburg (on-site) · Feb 2016 – Feb 2018

- Designed the UX/UI for an AI-driven receivables platform that grew to €25M in processed receivables within 18 months.
- Built white-label B2C payment journeys and self-service debt-resolution flows that met GDPR, PSD2 and financial-sector rules.
- Created flexible white-label design token systems that reduced deployment time for tier-1 enterprise rollouts.

Lead Interaction Designer

SBB Swiss Federal Railways (IVEG) · Public Sector

Freelance contract · Bern, Switzerland · Nov 2015 – Sep 2016

- Digitized field maintenance with an offline-first GIS mapping tool for infrastructure crews in remote locations.
- Eliminated manual paper processing by linking field data capture directly to back-office ERP databases.
- Built and documented a UI component library that met Swiss Federal accessibility and branding standards.

Senior Interaction Designer

frog (Client: Siemens/Unify)

Freelance contract · Munich · Sep 2013 – Jan 2014

- Designed **real-time collaboration UX** for "Project Ansible" (launched commercially as Unify Circuit) with Siemens product managers and software architects.
- Kept cross-platform parity across WebRTC video, chat, and document-sharing on Web, iOS, and Android.

Additional Enterprise Experience

- **Mercedes-Benz (Automotive)**: Design System Refactoring (2022 – 2023)
 - **Babymarkt (E-Commerce)**: UX Audit & Conversion Optimization (2022)
 - **Tagesspiegel (Media)**: Enterprise UX Architecture & Relaunch (2022)
 - **SAP (Enterprise IT)**: Fiori Design System & App Finder UX Architecture (2015)
 - **Scout24 Schweiz (Marketplace)**: Mobile & Web Search Architecture (2015)
 - **Telefónica O2 (Telco)**: UX Architecture & Design Lead for O2.de Relaunch (2011)
 - **Rossmann (E-Commerce)**: Multi-portal Enterprise E-Commerce Relaunch (2008 – 2012)
 - **Mercedes-Benz (Automotive)**: My Mercedes Customer Platform Architecture (2009)
 - **CTS Eventim (E-Commerce)**: Core UX Architecture for Eventim.de Relaunch (2008)
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Education

HAW Hamburg, Communication Design

Languages

German (Native), English (C1, Advanced), French (B1, Intermediate)

References

Executive references and contact details available upon request. References include leadership from WHATEVER.WORKS, Henkel, enfore AG, Hello Meet, collectAI, SBB CFF FFS, and frog Munich.